

Zoroastrianism or in Judaism. But there were classes or orders among the people. The division of the people into priests, warriors, and tillers of the soil frequently is met with in the *Avesta*. The institution of these separate orders is traced to Zarathustra. He is distinctly called the first Priest, the first Warrior, and the first Plougher of the ground.⁹ In the Bundeshesh, the three sons of Zarathustra are connected with these three classes. The first was the head of the priests. The second was the commander-in-chief in war. The third was the chief of the agricultural population.¹⁰ These orders were not castes, for they were not hereditary, nor was inter-marriage forbidden. The three orders are blended by all being derived from Zarathustra. It is implied that a son in any class might be born in the same home.¹¹

An artisan class is also sometimes mentioned.¹² Labor was held in respect. By cultivating a field a man was performing a religious act to the glory of Ahura Mazda. There probably was a servile class, which may have been composed only of captives taken in war. But it seems likely too that a free man might pawn away his freedom.¹³ The spirit and character of the Zoroastrian faith however is against slavery.

9. Yt. XIII:88-89.

10. Bund. XXXII:5.

11. Ys. XI:6.

12. Ys. XIX:17-18, Herod I:125, 101.

13. Vd. IV:2.